



Peas

These small dried beans come in many different colors.



Tepary beans

Around six to seven round peas are usually produced in each pod.



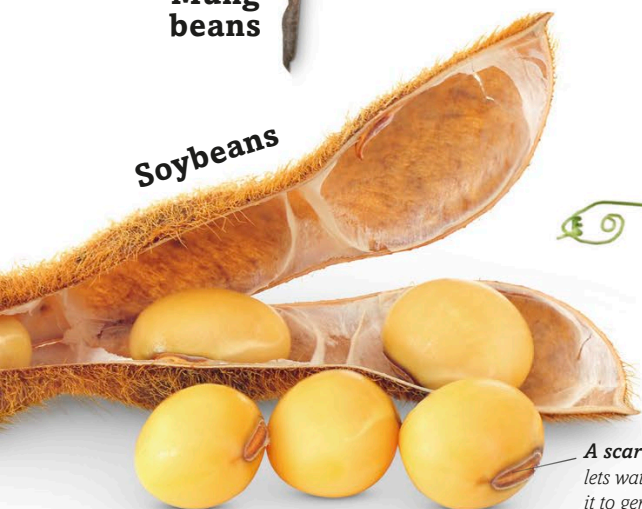
Borlotti beans

The red speckles disappear when this bean is cooked.



Mung beans

These tiny beans are often cooked with sugar in Asian baked goods.



Soybeans

A scar on the seed lets water in, allowing it to germinate.



Snow peas

The white flowers of the snow pea usually self-pollinate.

"Pulse"
comes from the Latin *puls*, meaning "thick gruel, porridge, or mush."

Unripe pods are eaten raw or in a stir-fry.

Today, we eat the fresh green seed pods of **winged beans**, **runner beans**, and **snow peas**, as well as the seeds themselves. **Fava beans**, **lima beans**, and **borlotti beans** also have tasty protein-filled seeds. **Soybeans** can be used to feed farm animals, make oil, and produce foods such as tofu.

Drought-resistant **tepary bean** plants can survive very dry conditions and thrive in hot countries like their native Mexico. It is important to cook all beans before eating because they contain proteins that can be harmful if not destroyed by heat.